

Word Study

“King Ahasuerus” = Xerxes in some translations.

“Shushan” = Susa.

Practical counsel on fasting (consult pastor/doctor as applicable).



Notes Section & Group Discussion

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BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

Wisdom in Response

 **Theme:** Prayer, the First Resort

 **Background Text:** 1 Kings 3:5–14; 2 Chronicles 1:7–12; 1 Kings 4:29–30

 **Key Verse:** 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this your great people?”

Appetizer – When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7 (WEB)

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today. ⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

Solomon has just become king. God appears to him in a dream and basically says, “What do you want Me to give you?” Instead of pretending he has it all together, Solomon admits he feels young and unsure.

Reflection Question

If God asked you, “What do you want Me to give you?” What would your honest first answer be?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Midnight Praise, Acts 16:25 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

At their worst moment—midnight, in pain, chained—they choose to:

- **Pray**
- **Sing hymns to God**

Everyone else is listening. Their worship turns the prison into a **sanctuary**.

Reflection Question

If someone listened to you in your “midnight moments,” what would they hear—complaints, silence, or praise?

Bite 2 – The Shaking, Acts 16:26–28 (WEB)

²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened and everyone’s bonds were loosened. ²⁷ The jailer, being awakened out of his sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, “Don’t harm yourself, for we are all here!”

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

But the first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stay, not because they’re stuck, but because they see the jailer’s life is on the line.